

AI usage policy

This document is long because I don't want anyone to have a nasty surprise later on. If you are not going to use AI/machine translation/Grammarly/similar tools at all, you don't need to read it.

To keep things simple in this document, I am going to refer to all sophisticated writing tools as "AI": so by "AI", I mean any sort of AI such as Chat-GPT, Claude, Deepseek, etc; any sort of machine translation tool; any tool like Grammarly; or any other sort of writing aid that is capable of generating text, translating text, or substantially editing text. If you are in doubt about whether or not a particular writing aid counts as AI by this definition, ask me.

Rationale

As I said in class, I want you to write the mini-paper yourself. The second half of the course is going to be spent working on the quality of your writing; we want there to be plenty of grammar and style problems in your mini-paper so you can edit and improve them for practice during the second half of the course.

At the same time, though, I recognise that some of you will be writing about complex ideas that you may find it extremely hard to express in English unaided. Therefore, I have tried to find a compromise.

Rules

The compromise is this: you may use AI to assist you with no more than 50% of sentences. Sentences written with the assistance of such aids must be highlighted in yellow like this, and the total wordcount of these sentences must be no more 50% of the total word count of the document.

For instance, if your introduction were 500 words long and contained 20 sentences, you could use AI to assist you with up to 10 sentences, and the total number of words in those 10 sentences taken together could not exceed 250 words.

Note: I'd encourage you to use AI less than this if you can. If you're writing about something very complicated, maybe you do need AI help with 50% of sentences. But if you're writing about something simple, probably you can cope with using AI less than this, and you'll get more benefit from this course if you use it less.

How marks in category 9 of the grading rubric will be awarded

Marks in category 9 will be awarded as follows. You will get 10/10 if all three of these requirements are met:

- (A) No more than 50% of sentences are highlighted in yellow.
- (B) The word count of the yellow highlighted sentences, added together, does not exceed 50% of the total word count of your mini-paper.

(C) When I read the non-highlighted sentences, I find it plausible that all of them were written by you, alone, without any use of AI.

Please note that the yellow highlighting must be applied to complete sentences. You cannot highlight half a sentence here and half a sentence there: highlight complete sentences only, even if your AI aid only changed some parts of the sentence.

Challenging your category 9 mark

My judgement about (C), of whether you wrote all the non-highlighted sentences yourself, may of course be wrong, so I am happy to give you the opportunity to challenge it. If I say you have failed on point (C) and you disagree, you will be able to challenge my judgement by making an appointment to see me in the CLE office. When you arrive at the CLE, I'll give you a writing task to complete by hand. You'll be able to bring a dictionary, grammar books, etc, if you want, but you will not be able to use any electronic devices. If the writing you produce during this controlled task convinces me that you did indeed write all the non-highlighted sentences in your mini-paper yourself without any assistance from AI, I will be delighted to increase your category 9 mark.

Clarification: using translation tools as dictionaries

Last year, a student asked if they could use translation tools to look up individual words. The answer is, of course, yes! Using a translation tool to look up individual words is no different to using a dictionary. The restriction is on using translation tools to convert whole clauses and sentences for you.